

PROJECTORS FOR HOMES

Want to have cinema-like experience in the comfort of your home? Get a projector and enjoy the show!

■ SWATI SHARMA

Your big-screen TV might not be big enough for your favourite movies and TV shows. That's a good-enough reason to buy a home-use projector as it will let you project wide-screen, high-definition videos onto a wall or viewing screen. You can also use it for making good-quality multimedia presentations at work.

But before investing your hard-earned money in a projector, decide how you plan to use your projector. You can either go for a multimedia projector or a home theatre projector depending upon your requirement. Read the following to know a little more about these.

Projectors to go for

Multimedia projectors are suitable for professionals who need visual aids for presentations and lectures. Just carry it along, hook your laptop, TV or DVD player to the projector and play audio and video, or text- and image-based presentations. These come in portable sizes allowing easy transport from one meeting to another. Many also include a carrying case for protection and easy storage. Optional remote control and inbuilt laser pointer provide even more flexibility.

Home theatre projectors, on the other hand, are not always portable as these have a lot more technology to hold. Usually, these also need a large baffle to help cool the projector.

One factor that might restrict you from purchasing a multimedia projector is that it is oriented towards computer display in an office setting where



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controlling lights might not be easy all the time. These are usually LCD projectors having their own LCD panel, and produce sharp and bright images. Most data projectors can display a full HD image but give an almost square 4:3 picture. Also, the picture can often blur if videos are played on these projectors as the LCD panel usually has a slow response time.

If your main interest is to watch videos, go for a home theatre projector. A dedicated home theatre projector can cope with fast-moving video, the subtle colours of a movie, and display a 16:9 wide-screen image. Else, you can opt for a multimedia projector with home theatre-compatibility. Let's discuss now home theatre projection technology.

Projection technology

There are two main projection technologies—digital light processing (DLP) and 3LCD. High-end options also have technologies like light-emitting diode (LED), direct-drive image light amplifier (D-ILA) and silicon x-tal reflective display (SXRD).

LCD projectors. These projectors

pass light through three small LCD panels, creating bright images appropriate for dimly-lit areas.

DLP projectors. These use a single digital chip and thus weigh less than LCD projectors. Offering smooth video performance, high contrast ratios and little pixelation, they are ideal for home theatre use.

Buying tips

When buying a projector, there are various features to keep in mind:

Resolution. It indicates the number of pixels produced and is expressed as two numbers, where the first number stands for horizontal pixels and the second for vertical pixels. The higher the resolution, the sharper the image.

Wide XGA (1280x800) and HD (1920x1080) are the most common resolutions for a home theatre projector. 1080 has about twice as many pixels in use than 800. This means that there are more and much smaller pixels (and therefore less likely to be visible) creating a smoother and detailed image. It also allows better compatibility with high-definition sources. So if your budget allows, go for a 1080p projector.